

General Knowledge

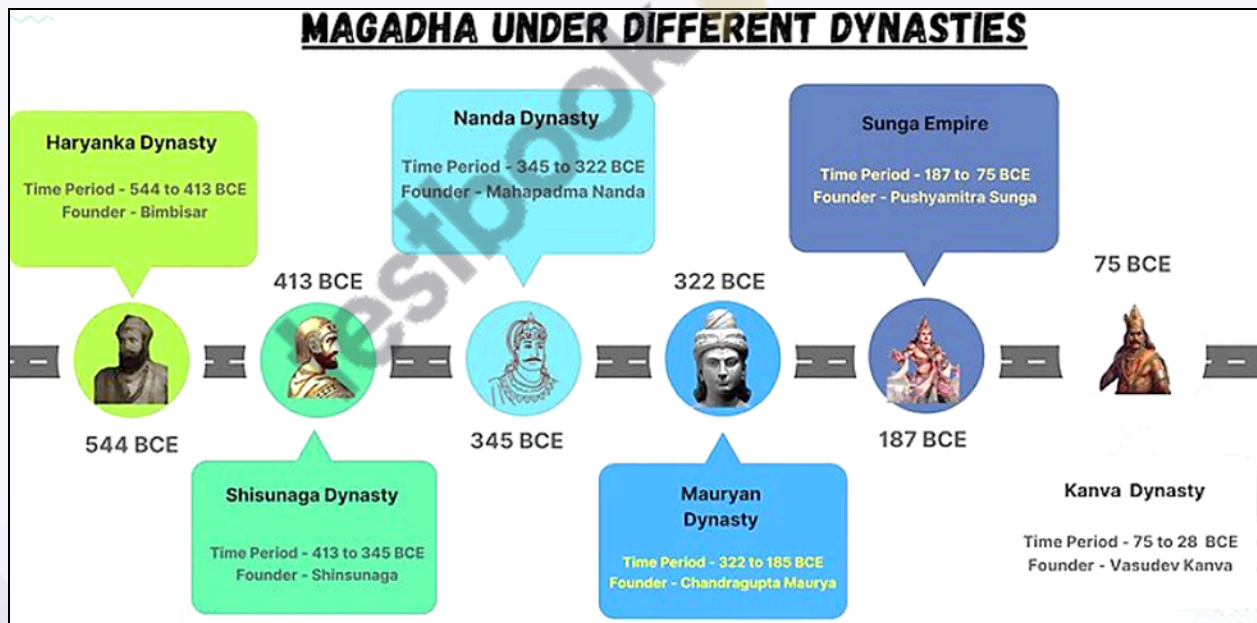
Ancient History

STUDY NOTES

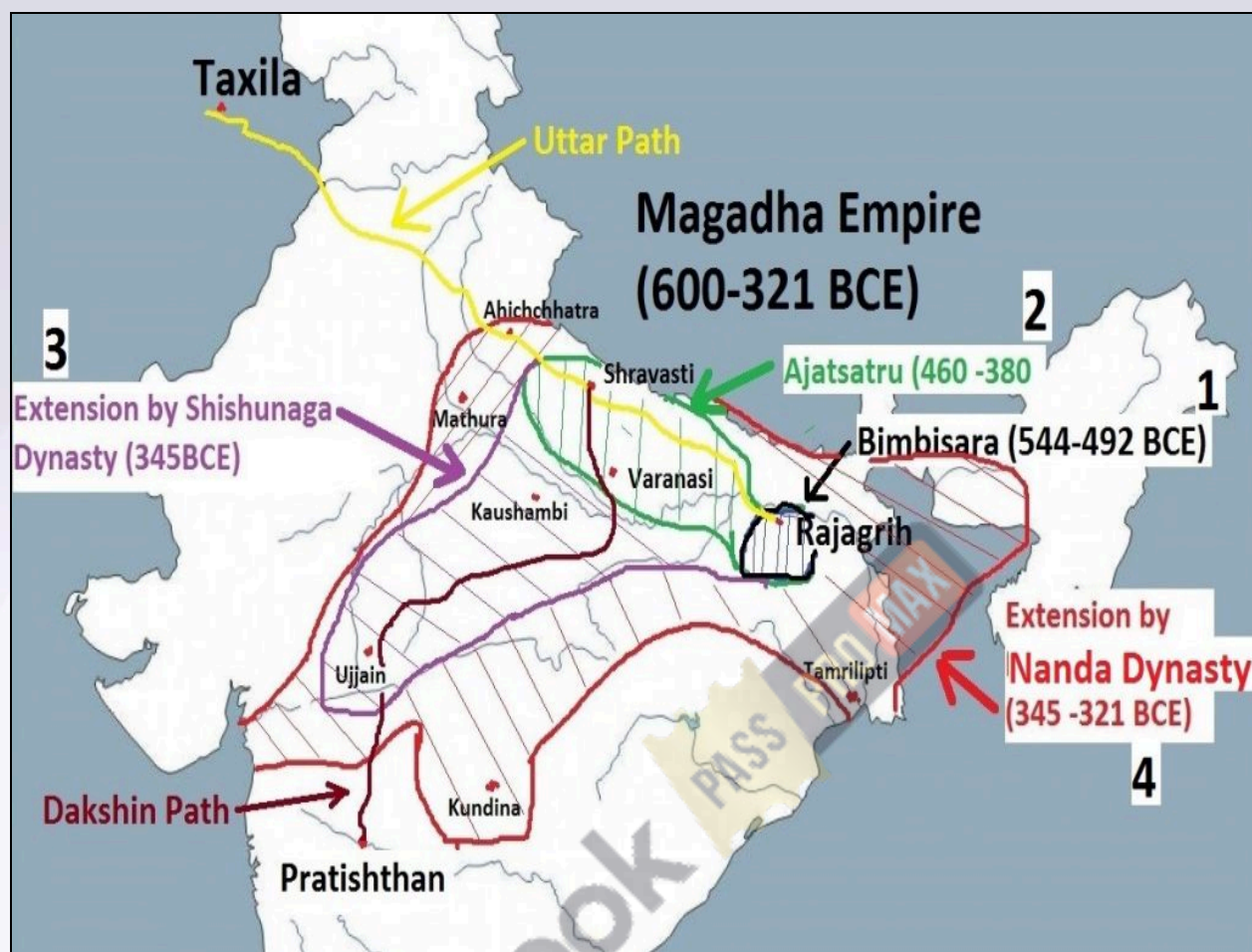
Magadha Dynasties



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There were constant conflicts between various Mahajanapadas and ultimately Magadha emerged as the largest Empire. The 1st Dynasty to rule Magadha was **Haryanka (founded by Bimbisara)**.



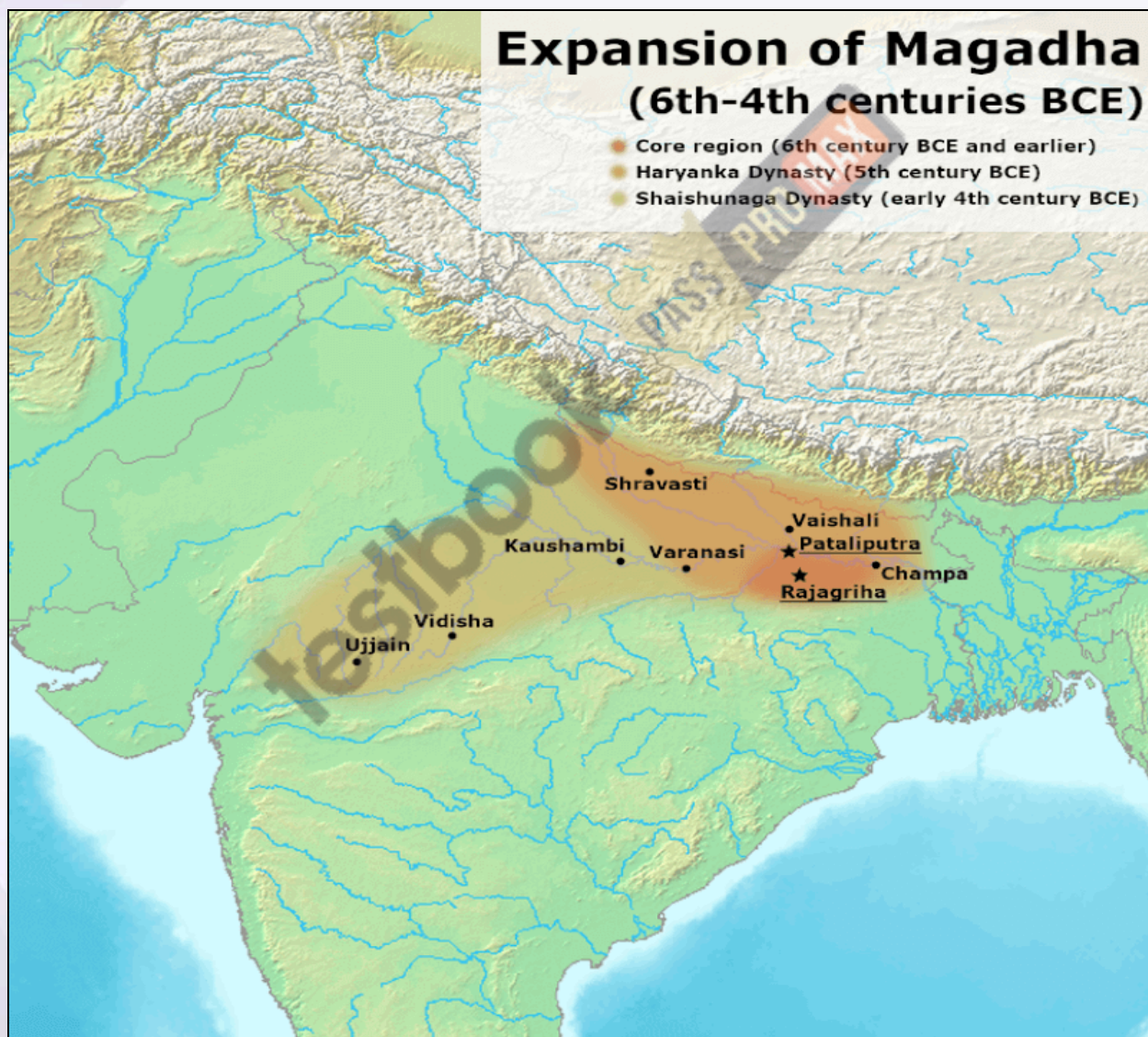
Sources of Information

- **Vedic Texts:** The **Brahmanas** and **Upanishads** refer to various **Janapadas** and **Mahajanapadas**.
- **Buddhist Texts:** Include **Vinaya Pitaka**, **Sutta Pitaka**, and **Abhidhamma Pitaka** which provide details about the Mahajanapadas.
- **Jainism Text:** The **Bhagawati Sutra** lists Mahajanapadas of that time.
- **Archaeological Evidence:** The **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** pottery provides physical evidence from the era, with remains discovered in **Ahichchhatra**, **Hastinapur**, **Kausambi**, **Ujjaini**, and other locations.
- **Archaeological Evidence** The **Hathigumpha inscription** at **Udayagiri** near **Bhubaneswar**, **Odisha**, records the construction of an **aqueduct** by **Mahapadma Nanda**.

Different Dynasties of the Magadha Empire

Haryanka Dynasty

- **Capital:** Rajagriha.
- The founder is debated, but many scholars believe it to be the **grandfather of Bimbisara**.
- Important rulers of the dynasty include **Bimbisara**, **Ajatashatru**, and **Udayin**.



Important Rulers of the Haryanka Dynasty

Ruler	Period	Key Contributions and Events
Bimbisara	544-492 BCE	- Contemporary of Buddha and Mahavira. Conflict with Avanti: Initially rivals with Pradyota, they became friends later. Sent Jivaka, his royal physician, to treat Pradyota's jaundice. - Conquered Anga (East Bihar) and its capital, Champa, vital for trade. - Strengthened position through matrimonial alliances: 1st wife: Mahakoshala from Kosala, received Kashi as dowry. 2nd wife: Lichchhavi Princess Chellana from Vaishali, mother of Ajatashatru. 3rd wife: Daughter of the Madra clan (Punjab).
Ajatashatru	492-460 BCE	- He was the most powerful ruler of the dynasty, known for his military conquests. - Defeated Prasenajit and annexed Kosala and Kashi. - Annexed Vaishali after defeating his maternal grandfather, Chetak. - Defeated the Mallas. - Introduced war engines like catapults (Mahashilakantaka) and chariots with maces (Rathamusala). - Began fortifying Rajgriha. - Arranged the First Buddhist Council after Buddha's Parinirvana.
Udayin	460-444 BCE	The new capital was founded at Pataliputra (modern Patna), located at the confluence of the Ganga and Son rivers.

Shishunaga Dynasty (~413-345 BCE)

- Founded by **Shishunaga**, who was originally a **minister (Amatya)** under **Nāgadāsaka**, the last ruler of the Haryanka Dynasty.
- **Capital**: Temporarily shifted to **Vaishali** during his reign.
- **Achievements**:
 - **Conquered Avanti** and integrated it into Magadha, ending the **100-year rivalry** between the two regions.
 - Succeeded by his son, **Kalasoka**, who presided over the **Second Buddhist Council** at **Vaishali**.
 - The **Nanda Dynasty** eventually usurped the throne, ending the Shishunaga reign.

Important Rulers of the Shishunaga Dynasty:

King	Key Contributions and Events	Capital
Shishunaga	• Originally an Amatya (minister) under Nāgadāsaka, the last ruler of the Haryanka Dynasty. • Founded the Shishunaga Dynasty in 413 BCE. • Temporarily shifted the capital to Vaishali. • Defeated and annexed Avanti, ending the 100-year rivalry between Magadha and Avanti.	Vaishali
Kalasoka	• Also known as Kakavarṇa. • Conducted the Second Buddhist Council at Vaishali. • Last ruler of the Shishunaga Dynasty. • Was murdered by Mahapadma Nanda, marking the end of the Shishunaga Dynasty and the beginning of the Nanda Dynasty.	Vaishali / Pataliputra

Nanda Dynasty (345 BCE – 321 BCE)

- The **Nanda Dynasty** was established by **Mahapadma Nanda** after he overthrew the last king of the **Shishunaga Dynasty**, **Kalasoka**.

- According to **Brahmanical texts**, **Mahapadma Nanda** was of **non-Kshatriya** caste. **Buddhist texts** describe the Nandas as belonging to the **Annatakula** (unknown lineage).



Important Rulers of the Nanda Dynasty

Ruler	Key Contributions and Events
Mahapadma Nanda	- Known as Ugrasena due to his large army. - Believed to belong to a non-Kshatriya caste (Brahmanical texts) or unknown lineage (Annatakula) (Buddhist texts). - First empire builder, claimed titles like Ekarat (sole sovereign) and Sarva-kshatrantaka (uprooter of Kshatriyas). - Added Kalinga to Magadha, brought back the image of Jina as a victory trophy. - Effective tax collection system and irrigation canals for agricultural growth. - Succeeded by his eight sons, collectively known as Navanandas.
Dhana Nanda	- The last significant Nanda ruler with a vast army was referred to as Agrammes or Xandrames by Diodorus (Greek historian). - Known for introducing Nandopakramani (a special measuring standard). - Reigned during Alexander's invasion of northwest India (327–325 BCE).